

Chapter 148-1

Gu Yixue was very straightforward—straightforward to a frightening degree.

Perhaps because she had achieved fame at a young age and had always been in a position of authority, she did everything according to three words: I like it.

Just like how she used newcomers, wrote her own scripts, and directed herself.

Gu Yixue's response to Sun Chengcheng was also very blunt. After she finished speaking, the air fell silent for a moment.

The other two girls were also newcomers who hadn't acted much. Their faces still carried a green, inexperienced look. These kids who had just come out of school had never seen this kind of situation. The two exchanged glances and simultaneously lowered their heads.

Sun Chengcheng paused for a moment before saying: "But I feel my compatibility with Huang Shan is quite high."

Gu Yixue looked at her, sizing her up for a few seconds: "I think your self-perception is mistaken."

Sun Chengcheng: "....."

"Huang Shan does have more scenes." Gu Yixue saw through her thoughts at a glance and bluntly exposed them. "But Guan Qingmin can become the white moonlight."¹

"They're all characters I've written." Gu Yixue sat there, her cool, detached eyes sweeping lightly over everyone present. "There's no favoritism toward any of them. Everything serves the plot."

Having said all that, if Sun Chengcheng argued further, she would be quite tactless.

Sun Chengcheng also knew how to read the room. She immediately apologized to Gu Yixue in a low voice: "Sorry, Director Gu. I just like this script too much."

"I also like it very much." Gu Yixue said. "But actors should have self-awareness about their positioning."

Sun Chengcheng pressed her lips together, looking embarrassed.

Gu Yixue curled her fingers and tapped them on the table: "I can understand that you haven't acted much and can't find your own positioning, so I'll help you find it. But... don't make me waste time on these kinds of things."

The sound of her fingers tapping the table was somewhat heavy.

After a moment, Gu Yixue stopped, and the room fell completely silent.

Only her calm voice remained: "Qi Tang, you'll play Chen Ruoyang. Tang Zui, you'll play Guan Li."

She assigned the roles concisely, then had them read through the script again. Only then did the meeting get on track.

When it came to interpreting characters, truly no one could surpass Gu Yixue.

Every line of dialogue in the script had been meticulously crafted. If you looked carefully, you could find connections between earlier and later parts, and you would be amazed without even realizing it.

Facing these relatively inexperienced actors, Gu Yixue showed no impatience.

On the contrary, when they raised serious questions, Gu Yixue answered very earnestly, responsibly helping them understand the characters—each character's emotional turning points, how to handle the major climactic events.

Parts that seemed unreasonable at first glance would prove to withstand rigorous scrutiny after reading them several more times.

Liang Shi had relatively more questions. For one, she had more scenes than the others; for another, she had read the script one more time than the others.

When discussing with Gu Yixue, it was more like a reasonable exploration of the character's possibilities.

The character of Huang Shan should be quite controversial, especially in the final scene where she shoots herself.

But after the discussion, Liang Shi was even more convinced of Gu Yixue's original version.

The meeting lasted nearly an hour, which was considered quite fast.

Gu Yixue had always been swift and decisive in these matters.

After the meeting ended, Gu Yixue mentioned the start date—the morning of the day after tomorrow, when they would hold the opening ceremony directly.

Sun Chengcheng had acted before, so she naturally knew that the script reading session was followed by the opening ceremony. Hearing that Gu Yixue had left a day in between, she was puzzled: "Why the day after tomorrow?"

Gu Yixue paused: "I have something to do tomorrow."

A simple and plain reason.

Sun Chengcheng had nothing to say to that.

Gu Yixue didn't lower her standards just because they were newcomers. She required them to have their lines memorized by the time filming began. As for all the beats and camera awareness, Gu Yixue would help them with those.

She said her crew didn't have many people, so many things wouldn't accommodate them.

When filming, it was work—no one should slack off. After filming was done, they could do whatever they wanted; she wouldn't care.

Their accommodation was at a hotel one street over, which was quite close.

The hotel's conditions were also pretty good—it was considered a production that was willing to spend money on its actors.

Everyone had no objections to this, so Gu Yixue asked everyone: "Does anyone have plans later? Want to go eat?"

Liang Shi was the first to speak: "I don't have anything going on."

Xu Qingzhu was on a business trip, so she had nothing to do even if she went home.

Sun Chengcheng also said she was free. The other two exchanged glances, knowing this was Gu Yixue treating them to a meal, so they accepted in unison.

Footnotes:

¹ White moonlight (白月光): A Chinese internet slang term referring to an unforgettable first love or an idealized person from one's past—someone pure, beautiful, and untouchable like moonlight. In storytelling, this character often represents the one who leaves a deep, lasting impression on others, even if they're gone or unattainable.